PARTICIPANT INFORMATION SHEET

Project Title: Communication-Focused Timetabling Support System

Version 1.0 **Date:** July 2026

Brief Summary of the Study

This study focuses on understanding communication challenges within university timetabling processes and developing a prototype system aimed at improving stakeholder interaction, timetable updates, and timetable slot change request management.

The study is intended for university students and academic stakeholders aged 20 or above who have experience interacting with university timetable systems. Participants under the age of 20 or individuals requiring special support considerations will not be included in the study.

Participation may involve interviews, questionnaires, or usability testing sessions related to timetable communication and scheduling experiences.

Who is Conducting the Research and Why?

This research is being conducted by Mohid Nadeem as part of an MSc Computer Science project at Nottingham Trent University under the supervision of Neil Sculthorpe.

The purpose of the research is to investigate communication and coordination challenges associated with university timetabling systems and explore how a communication-focused prototype system may help improve stakeholder interaction and timetable management processes within university environment.

Participation in this study is entirely voluntary. Participants may withdraw their participation and submitted responses within one week after participation without providing a reason.

What Will Taking Part Involve?

If you agree to participate, you may be asked to:

- Take part in a short interview discussing timetable-related experiences and communication challenges. You will be asked whether you consent to the interview being recorded.

  OR

  Complete a questionnaire regarding timetable communication and scheduling processes.
- Participate in a usability evaluation session involving a prototype system.
  - During the prototype evaluation, participants will complete a small number of timetable-related tasks using the Communication-Focused Timetabling Support System. The session will be conducted through an online Microsoft Teams meeting or an in-person meeting, depending on availability, and is expected to take approximately 10–20 minutes.

- The prototype will run on the researcher's laptop. Participants may take part in one of two ways:
  - by viewing the researcher's shared screen and directing the researcher on which actions to perform

    OR

  - by using TeamViewer (or a similar remote-access tool) to temporarily control the prototype on the researcher's laptop for the purpose of completing the evaluation tasks. Participants are not required to install or run the prototype on their own device.

Most participation activities are expected to take approximately 10–20 minutes depending on the activity involved. Participation will not require any specialist knowledge or technical expertise.

Possible Benefits and Risks

There may not be any direct personal benefit from taking part in the study. However, your feedback may help contribute towards improving communication efficiency within academic timetabling systems and support the development of more user-centred scheduling solutions.

The study is considered low risk. No sensitive personal information is intentionally being collected. Some participants may experience minor inconvenience due to the time required for participation.

All reasonable steps will be taken to maintain confidentiality and protect participant information. Such as, the information shared will be mentioned in the report anonymously.

What If Something Goes Wrong?

If you have any concerns regarding the study or your participation, you may contact the researcher or project supervisor using the details provided below.

What If I Do Not Want to Continue?

Participation in this study is voluntary. Participants may stop participating at any point during interviews or questionnaires.

Participants may also request withdrawal of their submitted responses within one week after participation. After this period, or once anonymised analysis has begun, withdrawal of data may no longer be possible.

How Will My Information Be Kept Confidential?

Information collected during the study will be used only for academic research purposes related to this project.

Participant responses will remain confidential and will be anonymised within the final dissertation report. Personally identifiable information will not be disclosed outside the project.

If participants choose the remote interaction option, TeamViewer access will be limited to the duration of the evaluation session and only for interacting with the prototype on the researcher's device. No files or personal data will be accessed from the participant's device. If the session is conducted through Microsoft Teams, recording will only take place where the participant has provided explicit consent.

Further Information

If you require any additional information regarding the study before deciding whether to participate, please feel free to contact the researcher or supervisor.

Contact Details

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